

ECO-5004 Microeconomics (1-Year MA)

Monsoon Semester 2026 (Aug–Dec)

Instructor:	Sumit Goel
Email:	sumit.goel@ashoka.edu.in
Office Hours:	Th 4:00 – 5:00 PM in AC-04-824
Teaching Fellow:	Dhrubajyoti Chakraborty
TF Email:	dhrubajyoti.chakraborty_phd23@ashoka.edu.in
TF Office Hours:	Fr 2:00 – 3:00 PM in AC-04-840
Lectures:	Tu – Th 11:50 AM – 1:20 PM in AC-01-LR-103

Course Description

This course introduces microeconomics. Broadly, microeconomics offers a framework for studying how institutions shape the utilization of scarce resources through the behavior they induce among economic agents. We begin by discussing why designing good institutions is challenging. Much of the course then focuses on the market mechanism, its efficiency, and its failures. It concludes with an introduction to game theory.

Learning Objectives

- Understand when markets promote an efficient allocation of resources, when they fail, and how such failures can be addressed.
- Reason formally about institutions using the tools of game theory.
- Formulate and solve constrained optimization problems.

Prerequisites

There are no formal course prerequisites. Students should be comfortable with basic calculus and mathematical reasoning at the level expected for entry into the MA programme.

Evaluation

This course is lecture based, and student assessment focuses on problem solving. The final course grade will be composed of the following components:

Component	Weight
Assignments/Quizzes	40%
Midterm exam	30%
Final exam	30%

There will be seven assignments and one surprise quiz, each worth 5% of the course grade. When computing the Assignments/Quizzes component, your lowest score among these eight assessments will be replaced by your highest score.

The numeric score will be converted to a letter grade according to the following scheme:

A	A–	B+	B	B–	C+	C	C–	D+	D	F
>95	90–95	85–90	80–85	75–80	70–75	65–70	60–65	55–60	50–55	<50

Attendance

Regular attendance in this course is expected and highly recommended.

Course Outline

Weeks	Topics
Week 1	Preferences: choice, preference, utility
Week 2	Aggregating preferences: impossibility theorems
Week 3	Housing economy: market mechanism, top trading cycles
Week 4	Consumer theory: utility maximization, demand
Weeks 5–6	Exchange economy: welfare theorems, externalities
Week 7	Producer theory: profit maximization, supply
Weeks 8–9	Variants: production economy, monopoly, asymmetric information
Weeks 10–12	Game theory: Nash equilibrium, auctions, Shapley value

Readings

We will follow, to some extent, the following book:

- [Models in Microeconomic Theory](#) by Martin J. Osborne and Ariel Rubinstein

This syllabus is subject to change at the discretion of the instructor.